DADAJI KI SAWAARI

A checkpoint racer that trains financial awareness and cyber safety

CDSL REIMAGINE IDEATHON 2026
APPROACH & PROTOTYPE NOTE
SCREENING ROUND

01 THE PROBLEM

India is investing faster than it is learning.

Demat accounts have crossed 23 crore, most of them opened in the last five years, while only about 9.5% of Indian households hold any securities-market product at all. The people arriving now are meeting a market they have no prior experience of, usually through a phone, often on the word of someone they have never met.

The gap is not a shortage of information. SEBI, RBI, the exchanges and the depositories publish warnings continuously, in many languages, free of charge. The gap is that the warning and the attack never meet. A circular is read on a Tuesday afternoon in a calm frame of mind. The scam arrives on a Friday evening: urgent, personalised, and written by people who test and improve it faster than any campaign can be revised.



Rs 22,495 cr
lost to cyber fraud in India, 2025

76%
of those losses from fake investment and trading scams

23 crore
demat accounts and climbing

9.5%
of households invest at all

76% FAKE INVESTMENT & TRADING SCAMS | **24% ALL OTHER**

Three quarters of the money India loses to cybercrime is lost to exactly the subject this project covers.

02 WHY AWARENESS CAMPAIGNS UNDER-DELIVER

The asymmetry of iteration

A fraud script is tested against thousands of targets a week and rewritten continuously. A public awareness campaign is revised annually. One side is running a live experiment; the other is publishing.

Recognition is not recall

A person can state the rule — never share an OTP — and share it twenty minutes later. Under pressure from an apparent authority the rule is not what surfaces. The urge to resolve the discomfort is.

Nobody finds out they were wrong

Someone who nearly fell for a scam receives no feedback at all. Learning requires knowing you were wrong, and ordinary life almost never supplies that safely.

03 WHAT ACTUALLY CHANGES BEHAVIOUR

REHEARSAL
The decision is practised under something like real conditions: time pressure, incomplete information, a cost to hesitating.

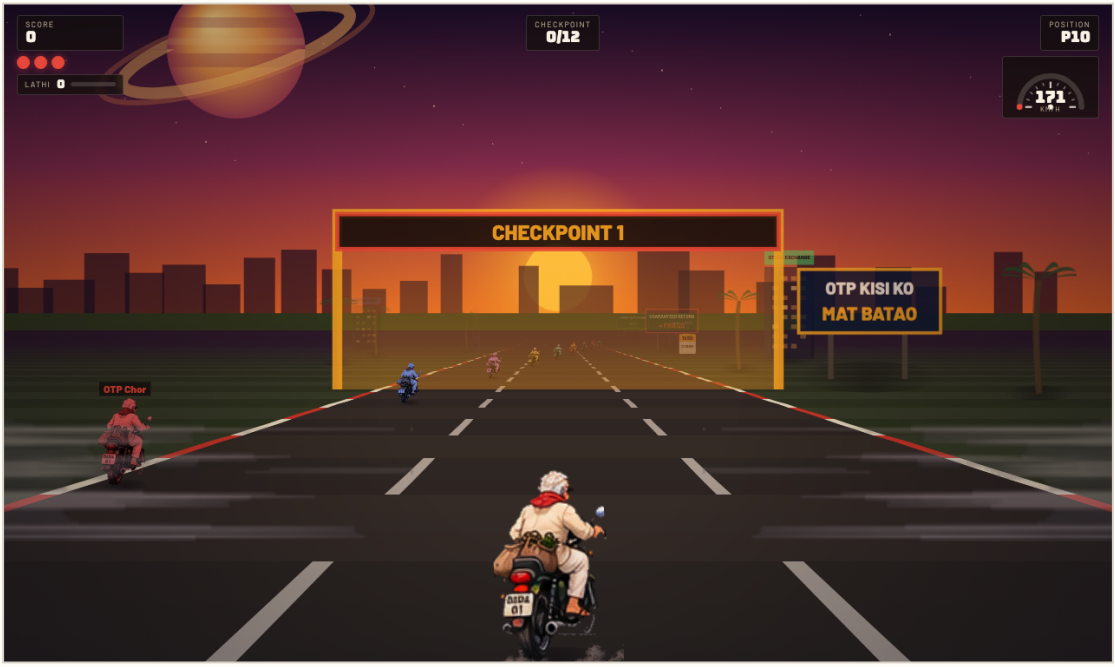
CONSEQUENCE
Being wrong costs something immediately. Without a cost the brain files the lesson as trivia.

RECALL
The correction arrives while the mistake is still live, and is short enough to be carried home.

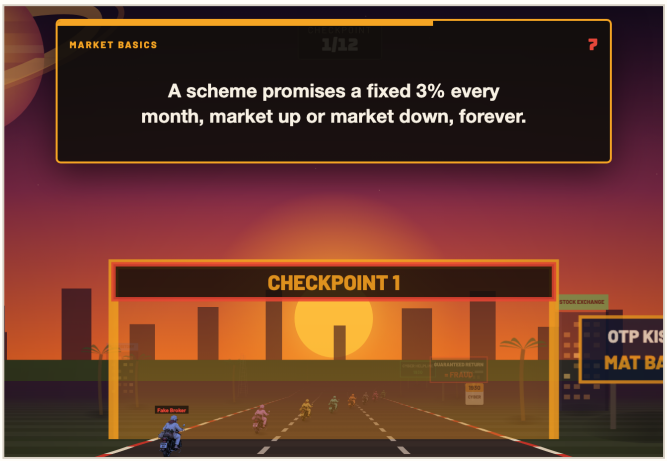
Any intervention that does all three will move behaviour. A game is simply the cheapest way to do all three at once.

Playable now, in any browser.

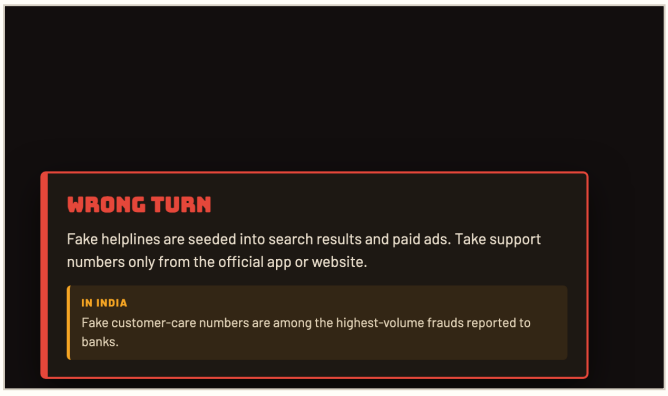
One HTML file and one sprite sheet. Nothing is installed, no account is created, no data leaves the device. It runs on a phone as well as a laptop.



Mid-race. Nine rivals, each named for a real fraud. The checkpoint banner spans the whole road, so no lane avoids it. The hoarding on the right is part of the syllabus, and the HUD carries score, lives, lathi charge, position and speed.



The checkpoint. Three seconds to read, then ten to answer — and the answer is given by steering into the left or right banner.



Wrong answer. The race stops, the reason is one sentence, and the Indian context sits underneath it.

ONE RUN, TWO TO FOUR MINUTES

RIDE	›	CHECKPOINT	›	ANSWER	›	VERDICT	›	RESULT
hold throttle, read the signs		road closes, 3s to read		steer left or right		why it was right or wrong		what you missed

Scenarios	28 in the bank, drawn fresh and shuffled every run
Split	14 cyber safety, 14 securities-market basics
Routes	6, 9 or 12 checkpoints — two to four minutes
Lives	three wrong answers and he is off the bike
Engine	pseudo-3D road, ~85 KB of code and 0.5 MB of art
Data collected	none — scores stay in the browser

05 WHAT MORE IS EXPECTED

The loop is proven. Four things stand between it and a measurable rise in literacy.

The prototype shows the mechanic teaches. It does not yet reach the people who need it most, and it does not yet tell anyone what it taught. Both are solvable, and both matter more than adding content.

Thirteen languages

Only the question text and the roadside signage are language-bound; the engine is not. Translation is a content file, not a rebuild. Until it exists the game reaches English-first students and nobody else.

A mode built for seniors

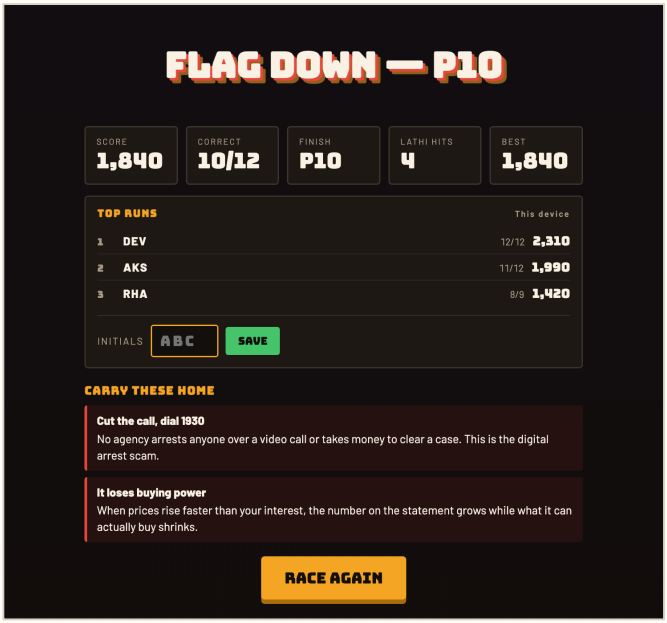
The hero is 92. The interface is not. Remove the countdown, enlarge the type, allow a question to be replayed, support a parent playing beside a grandchild. This is what turns a student game into a family one.

Measurement

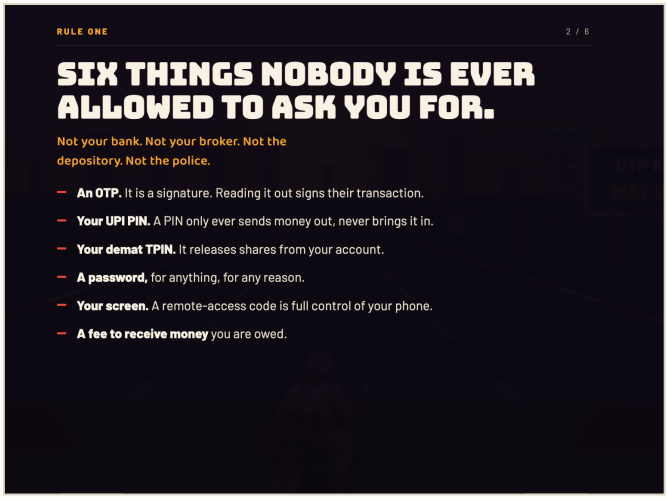
Record, anonymously and in aggregate, which scenarios are failed most often. That dataset is the real contribution: it shows where public awareness is thinnest, refreshed monthly rather than per survey cycle.

Distribution

A classroom and investor-camp mode: the two-minute route, a shared leaderboard for a room, and a printable debrief of what that group collectively got wrong.



The debrief. Only the questions you got wrong come back, as things to carry home. The leaderboard is this device only — nothing is uploaded.



Behind the Gain knowledge button: six slides that teach the same material outside the race, for anyone who wants it without playing.

WHAT THE 28 SCENARIOS COVER

14 CYBER SAFETY | **14 MARKET BASICS**

OTP calls · digital arrest · APK files · screen share · fake helplines · UPI collect · deepfakes · pump-and-dump · fake apps
nomination · CAS · SEBI registration · TPIN · debit alerts · SCORES · guaranteed returns · inflation · dabba trading

COMPLIANCE WITH THE BRIEF

- ✓ No investment advice, no trading, no product promotion, no security ever named.
- ✓ No login, no PAN, no personal data. Scores never leave the browser.
- ✓ All three audiences: students play it, a senior citizen is the hero, the content is what first-time investors get wrong.
- ✓ Both themes in one loop — financial awareness and cyber safety, which the brief credits.

AI tools were used as an aid in building this prototype and this document, disclosed as the rules require.
No third-party open-source libraries are bundled. Typefaces are served from Google Fonts under the Open Font License.